TEXT TYPE · B2 · LONG OR SHORT TASK

The article

Write for real readers

Word count	Register	Title	Structure
~250 or ~400 words	**Depends on the audience**	**Required – catchy!**	**5 paragraphs**

STRUCTURE AND LAYOUT

Catchy title – rhetorical question, alliteration, bold statement
Introduction – ~50 words – grab the reader's attention immediately
Body paragraph 1 – ~50–80 words – content point 1
Body paragraph 2 – ~50–80 words – content point 2
Body paragraph 3 – ~50–80 words – content point 3
Conclusion – ~50 words – leave the reader thinking

DO'S AND DON'TS

DO

- Know your audience (teenagers? general public? experts?)
- Use rhetorical questions to engage readers
- Address the reader directly ("you")
- Talk about personal experiences and emotions
- Use a topic sentence for each paragraph
- Write a conclusion that leaves something to think about
- Write an opening that makes people want to read on
- Use exclamation marks and direct speech if the register allows it

DON'T

- Don't be overly emotional or dramatic
- Don't forget who you're writing for
- Don't write a boring title
- Don't write like a formal report (no "It is believed that...")
- Don't ignore the publication context given in the task

WEAKER VS. STRONGER

WEAKER

In this article I am going to tell you about the advantages of doing sport.

STRONGER

Ask anyone who has hit the wall at kilometre 30: running is at least half a mental game.

Why it matters. An article has to pull the reader in. Announcing your plan sounds flat, while a concrete hook makes someone want to read on.

KEY TIP

Report vs. article: a report informs and recommends in a neutral tone. An article tries to make the reader feel something, so it can be personal and emotional. Always check where the article will appear: a school magazine needs a different voice from a serious newspaper.

MODEL TEXT

Screens Off, Life On? (~250 words · Semi-formal (school magazine) register)

The task. Last month your school challenged students to give up their phones for a whole week. Write an article about the experiment for your school magazine.

In your article you should:

- describe how participants felt at the beginning
- explain how everyday school life changed during the week
- say what you personally learned from the experiment

Write around 250 words. The model follows the five-paragraph plan: introduction, one paragraph for each content point, conclusion.

Text-specific Structure Language

Are you one of those people who check their phones within five minutes of waking up?[1] If so, you are definitely not alone. A recent experiment at our school challenged students to give up their phones for an entire week. The results were surprising.[2]

When the experiment started, most participants felt anxious and disconnected.[3] Several students admitted they instinctively reached into their pockets dozens of times a day. "I didn't even realise how addicted I was,"[4] one participant told me. The first two days felt long, and the breaks were strangely quiet.

However,[5] by day three something began to shift[6]: a handful of students started talking during breaks instead of reaching for their phones. By the middle of the week, the mood had completely changed[7]. Students who normally sat in silence were chatting and laughing at every break. Teachers noticed the difference too, reporting fewer disruptions and more engagement in class.

For me personally, the week was a lesson about habits.[8] I realised that I usually pick up my phone out of boredom and rarely because I need it. Without a screen to hide behind, I had to look at people and hold real conversations. I know this sounds old-fashioned, but it genuinely felt different – warmer, somehow.[9]

So, would I recommend a phone detox?[10] Absolutely, even if only for a few days. You might be surprised by what you notice[11] when you finally look up from that little screen. Honestly, the hardest part was admitting how much I had been missing all this time.

WHAT THE EXAMINER NOTICES IN THIS MODEL

The numbers match the marked passages in the model text.

1. **Rhetorical question – grabs reader immediately**: *"Are you one of those people who check their phones within five minutes of waking up?"*
2. **Hook – reader wants to know more**: *"The results were surprising."*
3. **Content point 1 – how participants felt at first**: *"When the experiment started, most participants felt anxious and disconnected."*
4. **Direct speech – fine in articles, not in reports**: *""I didn't even realise how addicted I was,""*
5. **B2 linking word**: *"However,"*
6. **Content point 2 – what changed during the week**: *"by day three something began to shift"*
7. **Turning point in the story**: *"the mood had completely changed"*
8. **Content point 3 – what you learned**: *"For me personally, the week was a lesson about habits."*
9. **Personal voice – fine in articles, not in reports**: *"I know this sounds old-fashioned, but it genuinely felt different – warmer, somehow."*
10. **Rhetorical question to conclude**: *"So, would I recommend a phone detox?"*
11. **Conclusion – leaves reader thinking**: *"You might be surprised by what you notice"*

USEFUL PHRASES

Openings

- Have you ever…?
- Do you remember the first time that…?
- Are you one of those people who…?
- There is nothing worse than…

Engaging throughout

- Can you imagine…?
- If you ask me,…
- You may not agree with me, but…
- I will never forget the time when…
- To be honest, it scares me when I think that…

Conclusions

- So next time you…
- The question is not whether… but when.
- Perhaps it's time we all…
- Food for thought, isn't it?

More online. On the website this text type also has a second model text (“Why learning a language is worth the struggle”, ~250 words · semi-formal) and a realistic borderline text with notes on where it loses marks: matura.bernhardgmeiner.com/article/